

Democrats vow probe of Trump’s \$1.8B fund

If they flip House, they’ll also try to block money to purported legal victims

BY MARIANA ALFARO

House Democrats plan to investigate and try to block President Donald Trump’s \$1.8 billion payout fund — created by the Justice Department to compensate people claiming to be targets of a politically “weaponized” justice system — if Democrats take back the House in November.

“We will get to the bottom of where every dollar has gone,” Rep. Jamie Raskin (D-Maryland), the top Democrat on the House Judiciary Committee, which oversees the Justice Department, said Tuesday. Raskin is expected to become chair of that committee if Democrats win the House. “They have just gone way too far this time, [and] the public is not going to put up with it.”

The Democrats are well-positioned to take back the House in the coming midterm elections and have vowed to use their investigation powers to check the Trump administration on many fronts. Democrats also have possible paths — though more remote — of taking control of the Senate.

The White House declined to comment on the Democrats’ threats to investigate the new payout fund, referring questions to the Justice Department, which did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Acting attorney general Todd Blanche on Monday announced the \$1.8 billion fund — paid for by taxpayers — as part of a settlement in the president’s lawsuit

SEE FUND ON A2

Big night for Trump in sweep of primaries

His favorites outperform his GOP foes in Georgia, Pennsylvania, Kentucky

BY HANNAH KNOWLES, DAN MERICA AND PATRICK MARLEY

President Donald Trump and his allies flexed their power Tuesday in primaries around the country, as Republican voters advanced their favored candidates and ousted one of Trump’s top Republican critics in Congress.

Trump’s biggest victory unfolded in Kentucky, where Rep. Thomas Massie (R) lost reelection after clashing with the White House and bucking GOP leadership on critical votes. But the president’s influence was evident across key races.

His show of force came days after he helped defeat Sen. Bill Cassidy (R-Louisiana), who voted to convict Trump in his 2021 impeachment trial. Several GOP lawmakers in Indiana also lost their seats this month after resisting Trump’s push to redraw the state’s congressional map.

Here are some takeaways from Tuesday’s primaries.

SEE PRIMARIES ON A4

‘We expect those numbers to keep increasing’



MOSES SAWASAWA/AP

Workers carry the coffin of a person who died of Ebola from a health center in Rwampara, Democratic Republic of Congo, on Wednesday. More than 130 deaths and hundreds of suspected cases have been recorded so far. **Story, A18**

White House resisted return of doctor with Ebola

BY LENA H. SUN AND LAUREN WEBER

The White House resisted allowing an American doctor exposed to Ebola while working in the Democratic Republic of Congo to return to the United States, according to five people familiar with the Ebola response who spoke on the condition of anonymity to share internal discussions, delaying the evacuation and care of Peter Stafford, who was ultimately transported to Germany.

Infectious-disease physicians who have cared for Ebola patients say the mainstay of treatment is early recognition of infection cou-

A sharp contrast with the care for Americans in 2014 West Africa outbreak

pled with effective isolation and advanced supportive care because an infection can progress within days to multi-organ failure.

Around the time that Stafford was transported, the wife and children of another missionary doctor from the same group returned to the United States, according to the head of the missionary group and a CDC official.

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention medical experts assessed the family twice before clearing the family of physician Patrick LaRochelle to return. Authorities at the U.S. port of entry and state health department officials’ risk assessment also determined they had not been exposed to a high-risk patient with Ebola symptoms, according to a CDC official and an individual familiar with the situation who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss the response.

LaRochelle is asymptomatic, according to a statement from the missionary group.

The administration’s reluctance to bring an infected Ameri-

can back to U.S. soil marked a sharp contrast with the 2014 West Africa Ebola outbreak, when the first two American patients were evacuated to Atlanta for treatment. Donald Trump harshly criticized the move at the time, and individuals familiar with the current response say the optics of bringing a possible Ebola patient into the country remain a major concern inside the White House.

“How incompetent are our leaders allowing these Ebola infected people to come into our country with all of the problems and danger entailed!” Trump posted on Twitter in 2014.

White House spokesperson

SEE EBOLA ON A18

BARNEY FRANK 1940-2026

Democrat was an influential congressman and a gay rights hero

The 16-term Massachusetts lawmaker led a sweeping overhaul of the financial sector after the Great Recession



CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

Rep. Barney Frank (D-Massachusetts) on Capitol Hill in 2008. His signature legislation emerged from the financial catastrophe that began with the collapse of the subprime mortgage market in 2007.

BY EMILY LANGER

Barney Frank, a Massachusetts Democrat who brought his sharp intellect and irrepressible wit to the U.S. House of Representatives, where he led a sweeping overhaul of the financial industry after the Great Recession and advanced gay rights as one of the first openly gay congressmen in history, died May 19 at his home in Ogunquit, Maine. He was 86.

His death was confirmed by his sister Doris Breay. Mr. Frank revealed last month that he had entered hospice care for congestive heart failure. Interviewed by Politico, he said he was preparing to release a book that was critical of his party’s left wing, which he blamed for alienating moderates. Progressive Democrats have “embraced an agenda that goes beyond what’s politically acceptable,” he said. “Until we separate ourselves from that agenda, we don’t win.”

Mr. Frank was a singular presence in the chambers and cloakrooms of Congress, where he served for 16 terms beginning in 1981, representing the Boston suburbs of Brookline and Newton. A self-described “left-handed

gay Jew,” he said he “never felt, automatically, a member of any majority.”

He traced his interest in politics to two formative events of his youth: the anti-communist witch hunts led by Sen. Joseph R. McCarthy (R-Wisconsin) and the lynching of Emmett Till, the 14-year-old African American who was almost exactly Mr. Frank’s age when he was killed in Mississippi in 1955 for allegedly flirting with a White woman. In politics, he said, he saw a way to bring about change.

After pumping gas at his father’s Jersey City truck stop, Mr. Frank won admission to Harvard University, where he studied government. In an era of pervasive antisemitism and homophobia, he long regarded public office as beyond his reach.

He concealed his sexual orientation as he made his way from Boston’s City Hall, where he served as chief of staff to Mayor Kevin H. White in the late 1960s and early 1970s, to the Massachusetts House of Representatives and then to Washington. Not until 1987, when his congressional seat was safe, did he come out

SEE FRANK ON A8

IN THE NEWS

San Diego victims The three people killed in Monday’s mosque attack were remembered for their selfless dedication and were described as pillars of the Muslim community. A7

Grade inflation Harvard faculty voted to limit the number of A grades for undergraduates at about 20 percent per class. A6

THE NATION **Massachusetts** is accused of using boundary lines to segregate schools by race and class. A6 **An-ex prosecutor** was charged with stealing a copy of a sealed report in a Trump inquiry. A6

THE WORLD **In Beijing**, Vladimir Putin failed once again to persuade Xi Jinping to sign off on a new gas pipeline, underscoring the limits of Russia’s dependency on China for energy sales. A12

THE ECONOMY **Borrowing costs** are climbing amid a global bond sell-off, reflecting investor fears about surging inflation and the nation’s growing debt burden. A14 **SpaceX**, set to debut on the stock market, disclosed \$13 billion worth of losses since 2023. A14

STYLE **“The Late Show,”** an American television institution, is going off the air, portending more changes to come. B1 **SPORTS** **The Hurricanes** are set to host the Canadiens to open their best-of-seven Eastern Conference Final of the playoffs. B7

THE REGION **Complaints** against D.C. police rose 25 percent during the heightened federal law enforcement presence in the city. B13

LOCAL LIVING **Extended warranties** are very profitable for companies — and often a terrible deal for you. You can do this instead.

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